

Best And Worst Foods For Cutting

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 10, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/UxRtEm3dikA> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter walks through five common seafood menu items, explaining which to avoid when cutting and what leaner swaps to make — focusing on eliminating breading, frying, and excess fat.

Contents

-  Swap 1: Lobster Roll → Lobster Tail
-  Swap 2: Coconut Shrimp → Grilled Shrimp
-  Swap 3: Fried Calamari → Grilled Octopus
-  Swap 4: Sea Bass → Cod or Tilapia
-  Swap 5: Crab Cakes → Scallops

Swap 1: Lobster Roll → Lobster Tail 0:00

- **Avoid:** Lobster roll — comes with extra additions (buns, sauces, fillers) that pile on unnecessary calories
- **Choose:** Lobster tail on its own
 - Clean, simple preparation with no extra "bull"
 - Brandon's personal rule: order lobster whenever it's on the menu — calls it a "big baller" move that also keeps him on track

Swap 2: Coconut Shrimp → Grilled Shrimp 0:00

- **Avoid:** Coconut shrimp — breaded and fried, adding a large amount of extra calories and carbs
- **Choose:** Grilled shrimp
 - Described as "fine, delicious, and nutritious"
 - Still feels indulgent without the caloric damage — "still eating shrimp like a big baller"

Swap 3: Fried Calamari → Grilled Octopus 0:00

- **Avoid:** Fried calamari — again, breaded and fried preparation is the problem
- **Choose:** Grilled octopus
 - Same seafood category, far fewer calories from frying
- Side note: Brandon's mom refuses to eat calamari because she says it's "like eating a bunch of rubber bands" — he admits he can't unthink it

Swap 4: Sea Bass → Cod or Tilapia t=22s

- **Avoid:** Sea bass — Brandon's personal favorite fish but flags it as too high in calories for a cut
 - "It's a very fatty fish — that's why it tastes good"
- **Choose:** Cod or tilapia
 - Both are white fish alternatives
 - **Way less calories and way less fat** compared to sea bass

Swap 5: Crab Cakes → Scallops t=46s

- **Avoid:** Crab cakes — two problems:
 - Unknown added ingredients mixed in
 - Then fried on top of that
 - "I don't eat no kind of cake" — personal rule against anything labeled a "cake"
- **Choose:** Scallops
 - **High protein** with virtually zero carbohydrates or fat
 - One of the cleanest macro profiles of any seafood option mentioned